

The Glorified Body - 5

Open to 1 Corinthians 15 and 1 Thessalonians. Put a marker at the last verse of 1 Thessalonians 3, and then we will be in chapter 4.

We have been talking about a no-no word in a lot of camps, a word not found in the Bible: rapture. Have you ever mentioned rapture and been corrected? "Well, you know, that word is not in the Bible."

Catching away, gathering together, caught up into the clouds. If that is not a rapturing experience, I do not know what is.

Would you not know that eventually The Born Again Trail would put the limb of the rapture in place? I have taken so long on The Born Again Trail that we are probably getting close to going home if I make it to the rapture. But He would want us to understand that too.

There have been many unanswered questions. People do not like to tackle them. When the person preparing you after you go home asks your relatives, "What do you want? Cremation? Is that in the will?" the question comes up often: is cremation all right?

If the trumpet sounds and the dead in Christ are going to rise, you have to have an interesting slant on cremation. If it is your body that will jump up, you would probably want to leave it as intact as you can.

But if you were a believer five feet from an atomic bomb when it hit, I do not think God could find a single strand of DNA to come back after. So we have a problem.

People ask me all the time, "Should I cremate them?" My suggestion is that cremation will not prevent you or your relatives from being glorified.

We had saints whose graves opened when the rocks were rent, and they jumped out. What we do not have is what they did afterward. Did they come out in a natural body or a glorified body? If it was a natural body, then when their spirits left with Jesus, did those bodies fall down on the ground and require reburial? Maybe they went back in, lay down, and the rock unrent.

Who were these people?

Romans 8 divided two dispensations: before the cross and after. Verse 26 says the Spirit helps our infirmities, and verse 27 says He who searches the heart knows the whole plan of God. Verse 28 says we know all things work together for the good of those who love God and are called according to His purpose, because now you are working God's plan through the power of the Holy Spirit.

By verse 29, Paul says, "those He foreknew." That is talking about all who slept before the cross. "Slept" is a nice King James word for dead.

Those He foreknew, He predestinated to be conformed to the image of His Son, that He might be the firstborn among many brethren. The reason they were predestinated was that there was no Firstborn image to be conformed to until the Firstborn was born.

Predestination and sovereignty concern the things God sovereignly moved on in provision. The cross was one of those things. He sovereignly made provision for you, and the rest is up to you.

Before the cross, when people stepped out of the body, they went down into a pleasant waiting place called Abraham's bosom. In Jesus' day, that represented the promise He made to them of Christ. They were waiting in the promise.

In 1 Corinthians 15, Paul says that by Adam came death and by Christ all are made alive. When he talks about resurrection in that chapter, he takes it all the way back to Adam.

Those He foreknew, He predestinated. Those He predestinated, He called to the cross. Those He called, He justified. Those He justified, He also glorified. The people who came out of their graves around Jerusalem were part of that.

Where did they go? After Jesus finished His mission, they left with Him.

But those were not the only people glorified. Everyone who had died anywhere and was foreknown was included. Why do we have only one documented record, in Jerusalem? Because those in Jerusalem were witnesses who rose with Him to testify.

When He comes to get you and me, we who are alive and remain will be caught up to meet Him in the clouds, and we will be glorified in a moment. The people around the world who were glorified in that day were caught up and glorified with Him. They were justified in their spirits when He rose from the dead, then caught up and glorified when He returned to heaven.

The witnesses in Jerusalem were not glorified and running around on the planet appearing to people. They appeared as witnesses. We do have an infallible record of people jumping out of their graves when He did.

The Corinthians were influenced by Greek ideas about the spirit floating through the Elysian fields. Many did not really want a body. Religion always tries to slip something untrue into truth.

So Paul dedicates 1 Corinthians 15 to the resurrection. The subject is the resurrection of your physical body.

He begins:

Moreover, brethren, I declare unto you the gospel which I preached unto you...

After straightening out error in the church and the proper order of spiritual operations, Paul says, "Moreover." In other words, "I am going to build on this. Here is more error."

He says Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, was buried, and rose again the third day according to the Scriptures. He was seen by Cephas, then the Twelve, then more than five hundred brethren at once, then James, then all the apostles, and last of all by Paul, as one born out of due time.

Paul says:

By the grace of God I am what I am...

He labored more abundantly than all the apostles, yet not him, but the grace of God within him. That is why I say that when I found out He would carry my load, I quit. When I found out His grace is the fullness of His standing in me, and that it can stand under anything, accomplish anything, and conquer anything, what would be the point of worrying?

When I found out He does not sleep, I could not think of one good reason to stay up with a problem when He is staying up with it.

Peace is to your body what praying in tongues is to your spirit.

Paul says he labored in grace. Jesus enabled him to do it by His grace.

Paul continues:

Now if Christ be preached that he rose from the dead, how say some among you that there is no resurrection of the dead?

If there is no resurrection of the dead, then Christ is not risen. If Christ is not risen, preaching is vain, faith is vain, and we are false witnesses. Those who have died in Christ have perished. If in this life only we have hope in Christ, we are of all men most miserable.

Moses chose God and the wilderness rather than the pleasures of sin. The Bible admitted sin has pleasures. If believers had the death nature, resisted sin because of a false doctrine, lived miserable lives, and then died with no resurrection, what would be the point?

But now Christ is risen from the dead and become the firstfruits of them that slept.

Who are those who slept? Those who died before the cross. If He is the Firstborn and became the firstfruits of them that slept, then He is talking about that same group: those He foreknew, predestinated, called, justified, and glorified.

Paul's wording goes all the way back to Adam:

For since by man came death, by man came also the resurrection of the dead. For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive. But every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits; afterward they that are Christ's at his coming.

The subject is the resurrection of the body. Every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits, then afterwards those who are Christ's at His coming. That is us. We receive the resurrected body at His coming.

The people in Matthew whose graves opened were the firstfruits of those who slept.

Romans 8 and 1 Corinthians 15 are speaking of the same thing. Romans 8 says the Holy Spirit searches the heart and knows God's whole plan. Then Paul moves back before the cross and says those He foreknew He predestinated, called, justified, and glorified.

First Corinthians 15 says every man in his own order: Christ the firstfruits, then afterwards those who are Christ's at His coming.

The question remains: what if you were blown up by an atomic bomb? What if a shark ate you? What if you were cremated and scattered over a valley? If God is looking for natural DNA, some people have none left.

Those questions were being posed to Paul. I wish I had the list of questions, but I understand the answer. Because I understand the answer, I understand the question.

Now Paul gets technical. What body do we come out with?

The graves opened on that day as witnesses of His resurrection. The rocks were rent, and those men came out. But if you were eaten by a shark, you have no tombstone anywhere.

Paul says Christ must reign until all enemies are under His feet. The last enemy destroyed is death.

Then he says:

Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all?

How would we know what that means? Nobody does that anymore.

Because of persecution, many people were dying. It was evidently a common practice that when believers died in persecution, prison, or elsewhere before they could be baptized, other believers stood in and were baptized in their place.

Baptism represents being baptized into His death and resurrected with Him: the burial of the old man and the resurrection of the new. They wanted to be sure those dead believers had a resurrection. Paul's question is, if the dead are not raised, why bother being baptized for them?

Then Paul says:

Why stand we in jeopardy every hour? I protest by your rejoicing... I die daily.

He fought with beasts at Ephesus. History indicates Paul was not built like a gladiator. He was rather short, frail, with a hooked nose, balding, and grayish eyes. But what he lacked in stature, he made up for in faith.

He says if the dead do not rise, there is no advantage in facing all that. Let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die.

Then:

Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners. Awake to righteousness, and sin not...

Paul says, "Some have not the knowledge of God. I speak this to your shame."

Paul answers:

But some man will say, How are the dead raised up? and with what body do they come?

Paul's response is, "Fool." The King James added "thou" in parentheses. He just says, "Fool."

He says:

That which thou sowest is not quickened, except it die: And that which thou sowest, thou sowest not that body that shall be, but bare grain...

Any seed you sow is cut off from the plant and suffers its own death. What seed comes alive unless it is sown?

Paul is answering the question, "What kind of body do we come out of the grave with?" Inside the bare grain is the DNA and programming for the entire plant that will clothe itself with its own body. You do not drag a tree out and plant it in the ground. You sow the seed. In the seed is the program for the body to come.

But God giveth it a body as it hath pleased him, and to every seed his own body.

Every seed has the program for its own body.

Paul says there are different kinds of flesh: men, beasts, fish, birds. There are also celestial bodies and terrestrial bodies, one glory of the sun, another of the moon, and another of the stars.

Then:

So also is the resurrection of the dead. It is sown in corruption; it is raised in incorruption: It is sown in dishonour; it is raised in glory: It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power: It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body.

When he says it is raised in power, that is an understatement. You are going to have a body that bridges two worlds: this one and that one, the new heaven and new earth, heaven and spiritual realms, and realms with glorified bodies.

This verse unlocked the chapter for me:

It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body, and there is a spiritual body.

Many teachers separate the house you are wearing from your spirit and say the spirit man is the spiritual body and this is the natural body. After that, the chapter no longer breaks open because the rest does not make sense.

But through revelation and assimilation, I understood that Paul is talking about this body being sown natural-based, and when it is raised, it is raised a glorified, spiritually based body adapted to the operation of my spirit.

Paul says:

The first man Adam was made a living soul; the last Adam was made a quickening spirit.

The first man gave you your spirit, soul, and body. The last Adam, Christ Jesus, is a quickening Spirit. He has given you your spirit, your soul, and when He is done, the same seed you were born again of will produce the glorified body you will receive when you are glorified.

The first man Adam gave you the body you have now because it was in the seed God created him with. It was in his DNA.

Romans 6 says I was baptized into Jesus' death so I might be made a partaker of His resurrection. My old man, spirit, soul, and body, was sown into His death. When I came out of the grave with Him, in my spiritual DNA, I had the blueprint for my glorified body. At the sound of the trump, if I am standing on this planet, it will appear upon my frame.

Paul continues:

Howbeit that was not first which is spiritual, but that which is natural; and afterward that which is spiritual. The first man is of the earth, earthy: the second man is the Lord from heaven. As we have borne the image of the earthy, we shall also bear the image of the heavenly.

We have borne the express image of the earthly, spirit, soul, and body. We shall also bear the express image of the heavenly, spirit, soul, and body.

Paul says:

Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God; neither doth corruption inherit incorruption. Behold, I shew you a mystery; We shall not all sleep, but we shall all be changed, In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trump...

The dead shall be raised incorruptible, and we shall be changed.

What kind of body appears on any seed? How is the seed quickened unless it dies? My seed was sown when I raised my hands, was baptized into Jesus' death, and was resurrected in His likeness.

Just as Adam gave me DNA and a body formed on my skeleton and frame, my resurrection with Christ gave me an incorruptible seed. My spirit has already been born again, but within that incorruptible seed is the program that carries the DNA for my glorified body.

If you are watching when the time comes, you will see something amazing.

"But what if I am gone? What if I was burned, eaten, or destroyed?"

The glorified body is in the seed.

Go to 2 Corinthians 5. Paul adds another piece of meat to this.

Second Corinthians 4:18 says:

While we look not at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen...

Things seen are temporal. Things not seen are eternal.

Then 2 Corinthians 5:1 says:

For we know that if our earthly house of this tabernacle were dissolved, we have a building of God, an house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens.

If this earthly house were dissolved like in acid, an atomic bomb, a shark, or cremation, we have a building of God, a house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens.

In this body we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed upon with our house from heaven. We do not want to be unclothed, but clothed upon, that mortality might be swallowed up in life.

This is the same teaching as Romans 8. Romans 8 says He saved us in hope of the glorified body, and meanwhile the Spirit helps our weaknesses while we are in this one. Second Corinthians 5 says He has given us the earnest of the Spirit.

The Holy Spirit is your earnest. He is all you need while waiting for your glorified body. Romans 8 gives the detail: He searches the heart, knows your weaknesses, and makes intercession according to the will of God because you are groaning and burdened in a tabernacle that will soon be clothed upon from above.

Second Corinthians 5 continues:

Therefore we are always confident, knowing that, whilst we are at home in the body, we are absent from the Lord: For we walk by faith, not by sight: We are confident... and willing rather to be absent from the body, and to be present with the Lord.

If you are not in this body, you are with Him.

If I went home in front of you right now, I would expect you to have a party tonight. I would rather have a bigger one when I leave. I step out of this body, and I am home. The first thing I will do is look around and say, "Yes, I was done." Then I will look for my angel. "Where is the hidden one?"

He is coming back with me. If we go home before Jesus comes, we are coming back with Him. Then the dead in Christ rise. We will get into Thessalonians.

Romans 6 says:

What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound? God forbid. How shall we, that are dead to sin, live any longer therein?

Paul is shocked by the idea.

Know ye not, that so many of us as were baptized into Jesus Christ were baptized into his death? Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death...

We were sown corruptible and raised incorruptible. We were baptized into Jesus Christ, baptized into His death. As Paul says in 1 Corinthians 15, how can a seed be quickened unless it dies?

Romans 6 continues:

For if we have been planted together in the likeness of his death, we shall be also in the likeness of his resurrection: Knowing this, that our old man is crucified with him...

God gives every seed its own body. You cannot see it, but it exists in the DNA. We have been planted together in His death and quickened together with Him. Within that planting and resurrection is the DNA for your glorified body.

You are going to get one no matter what happened to this one.

Hallelujah.